THE ROSETTA TONE CYCLE-SYNCING NUTRITION GUIDE

HOW TO NOURISH YOUR BODY THROUGH EVERY PHASE OF YOUR CYCLE

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Welcome to Your Cycle-Syncing Nutrition Guide

Working with your body, not against it

This project has been on my heart for years. After being on birth control for more than a decade, I never really learned how to connect with the natural rhythms of my body. I was taught that "anytime you have sex, you'll get pregnant," and it took growing older, and learning more, to realize just how much more there is to understand about our cycles.

Growing up, no one handed us a manual for how to nourish our bodies through hormonal changes, so this guide is about learning to listen to your body instead of fighting against it. Cycle syncing is simply using your menstrual cycle as one tool to help guide your nutrition, movement, and self-care based on how you're feeling.

But let's be clear: cycle syncing isn't a cure-all, and it doesn't work the exact same way for everyone. Your experience of each phase can vary from month to month, and some women (especially during perimenopause) may experience less predictable or very different hormonal patterns. You don't need to force yourself into a four-phase formula.

You're about to dive into how to fuel your body through every phase of the month, how to stay on track while traveling or dining out without feeling bad about your food choices, and how to actually read food labels without needing a science degree. Oh, and we're busting a few nutrition myths along the way too.

I'm Rosetta, a NASM Certified Personal Trainer and Nutrition Coach, and I'm here to help you ditch the food confusion and build cycle-syncing awareness.

Take your time with this guide and use it as a resource, not a rulebook. Come back to it as you learn more about your body, notice new patterns, and move through different seasons of your hormonal journey. Take what resonates, leave what doesn't, and remember: your body is the expert. Happy reading!

Rosetta Riley

A Little History Before We Get Into It...

ANCIENT WISDOM MEETS MODERN SCIENCE

Let's take a quick moment to honor the wisdom of indigenous cultures that have known for centuries what we're just starting to learn today—our cycles are powerful, and aligning our lives with the natural rhythms of our bodies (and the Earth) isn't anything new.

Take the Native American Tribes, like the Navajo and Lakota, who saw menstruation as a sacred time for reflection and rest (*Indian Health Service*, 2018). Then there's the Mayan women, who believed their menstrual cycles were intimately connected with the lunar phases (*The Maya and Their Calendar*, 2020). Don't forget the Aboriginal women of Australia, who synced their activities with the moon's cycle, too (*Aboriginal Women's Wisdom on the Menstrual Cycle*, 2022).

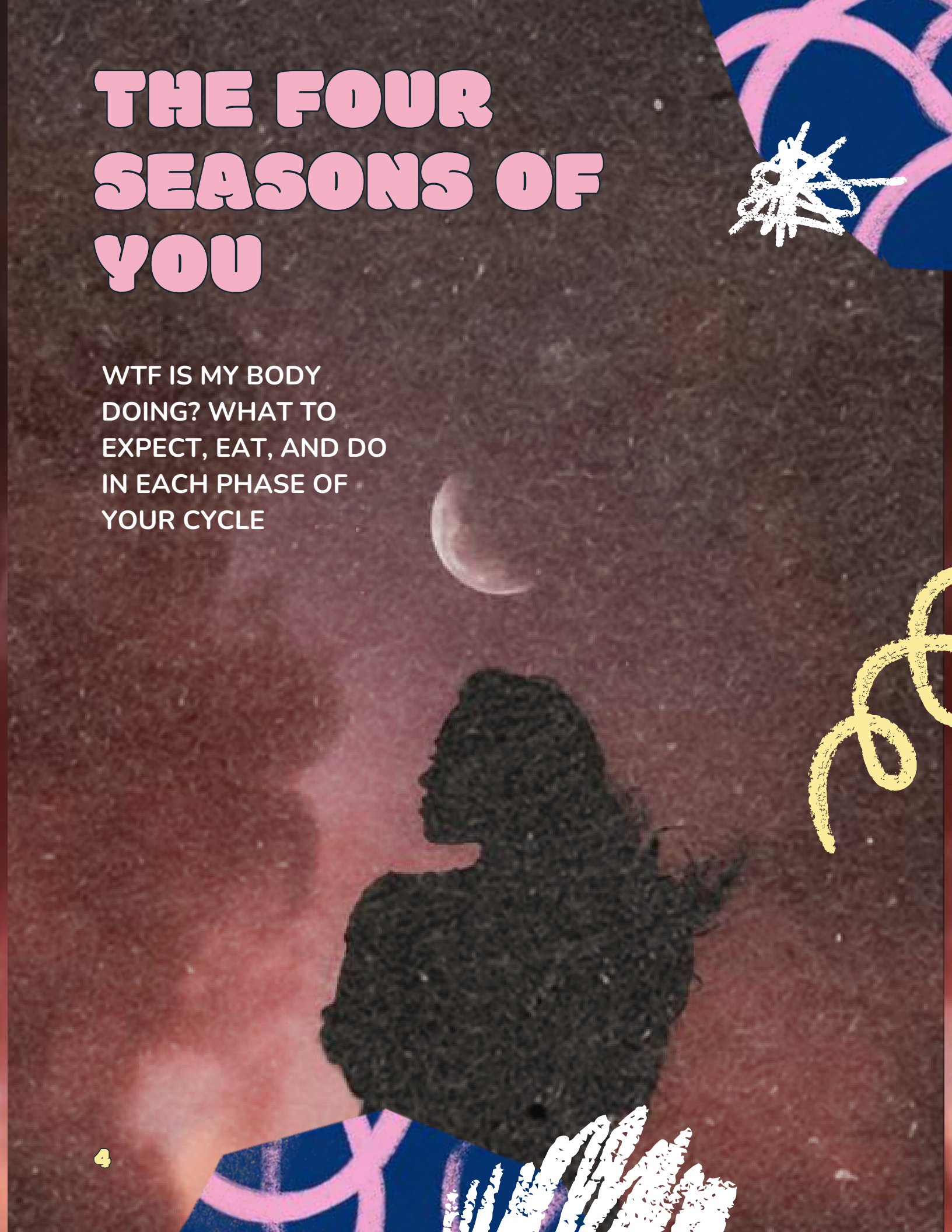
Cycles of the Earth, Cycles of You

And, in Africa, the Zulu and Xhosa tribes (South Africa) have long respected the menstrual cycle as a time for reflection and spiritual connection, with many rites of passage for young women rooted in this natural cycle (*South African Indigenous Knowledge Systems*, 2017).

So while modern science is still catching up, these traditions have known for ages that syncing with your natural rhythm is a game-changer. **We may not have all the data yet, but that doesn't mean these practices aren't powerful.**

THE FOUR SEASONS OF YOU

WTF IS MY BODY DOING? WHAT TO EXPECT, EAT, AND DO IN EACH PHASE OF YOUR CYCLE



Day 1-5

Winter: Menstruation

restorative yoga / gentle walks / warm soups & stews / iron-rich veggies / seaweed / cozy / introverted / intuitive / be the blanket burrito you were born to be

Day 6-13

Spring: Follicular

fresh start energy /light cardio / strength training / new fitness challenge / leafy greens/ eggs/ quinoa/ fermented foods / chicken / fish / curious/ energetic/ social /get sh*t done!

Day 14-16

Summer: Ovulation

main character energy/ peak confidence and stamina / take up space / heavy lifting / HIIT / dance / raw veggies / smoothies / lean protein / bold / magnetic / charming

Day 17-28

Fall: Luteal

time to slow down /PMS / Pilates / lower-impact workouts / root veggies / sweet potatoes / warm grains / magnesium-rich food / dark chocolate / sensitive / craving comfort / low-key / rest is revolutionary

SCIENCE SAYS SO (KINDA)

To keep it real with you, cycle syncing isn't exactly *new*. Indigenous women and ancient healing systems have been tuning into the rhythm of their bodies long before it became a buzzword on your feed. But when it comes to hard science? The research is... still catching up.

That's not to say these practices don't work (because hello, many of us are thriving out here). It just means the data is a little light, a little inconclusive, and often missing us entirely. Why? Because most health and fitness studies were designed with men as the default and totally skipped the hormonal rollercoaster women ride every month. Cute, right?

As a NASM-certified nutrition coach trained in evidence-based practice, I gotta give it to you straight: **even though many women are just now learning what the luteal phase even is, the science is still unfolding.**

Most health and fitness studies were designed with men as the default and totally skipped the hormonal rollercoaster women ride every month.

But that doesn't mean we throw it out, it means we stay curious, self-aware, and, most importantly, in tune.

This guide? It's here to empower, not prescribe**. Everyone is different. Some of my clients feel more energy during their luteal phase. Use what feels good, leave what doesn't,** and always talk to a healthcare provider before making any major changes.

SCIENCE SAYS SO (KINDA) SOURCES*

[Dietary Phytoestrogens and Hormonal Health:] This study explores how dietary phytoestrogens, found in foods like soy, may influence hormone levels, though human trial results remain inconclusive.

[Cycle Syncing: Nutrition and Exercise Throughout Your Menstrual Cycle:] An overview of how aligning diet and exercise with menstrual phases might support well-being, noting that while the concept is popular, more research is needed.

[Cycle Syncing for Hormonal Balance:] Explores the potential benefits of adjusting dietary choices in accordance with menstrual cycle phases to alleviate symptoms and enhance energy levels.

[Cycle Syncing Overview by Yale New Haven Health:] Provides an introduction to cycle syncing, explaining how adjusting diet and exercise to menstrual phases may support the body's natural rhythms

[Dietary Energy Intake Across the Menstrual Cycle:] Reviews existing research on how energy intake may vary throughout the menstrual cycle, highlighting the need for more high-quality studies.

*THESE RESOURCES OFFER INSIGHTS INTO THE COMPLEX RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN NUTRITION AND WOMEN'S HORMONAL HEALTH. WHILE THEY PROVIDE VALUABLE INFORMATION, IT'S ESSENTIAL TO CONSULT WITH HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS BEFORE MAKING SIGNIFICANT DIETARY CHANGES.

MACROS, MACROS, MACROS

PROTEIN

CARBS

FATS

THE BIG THREE

Protein

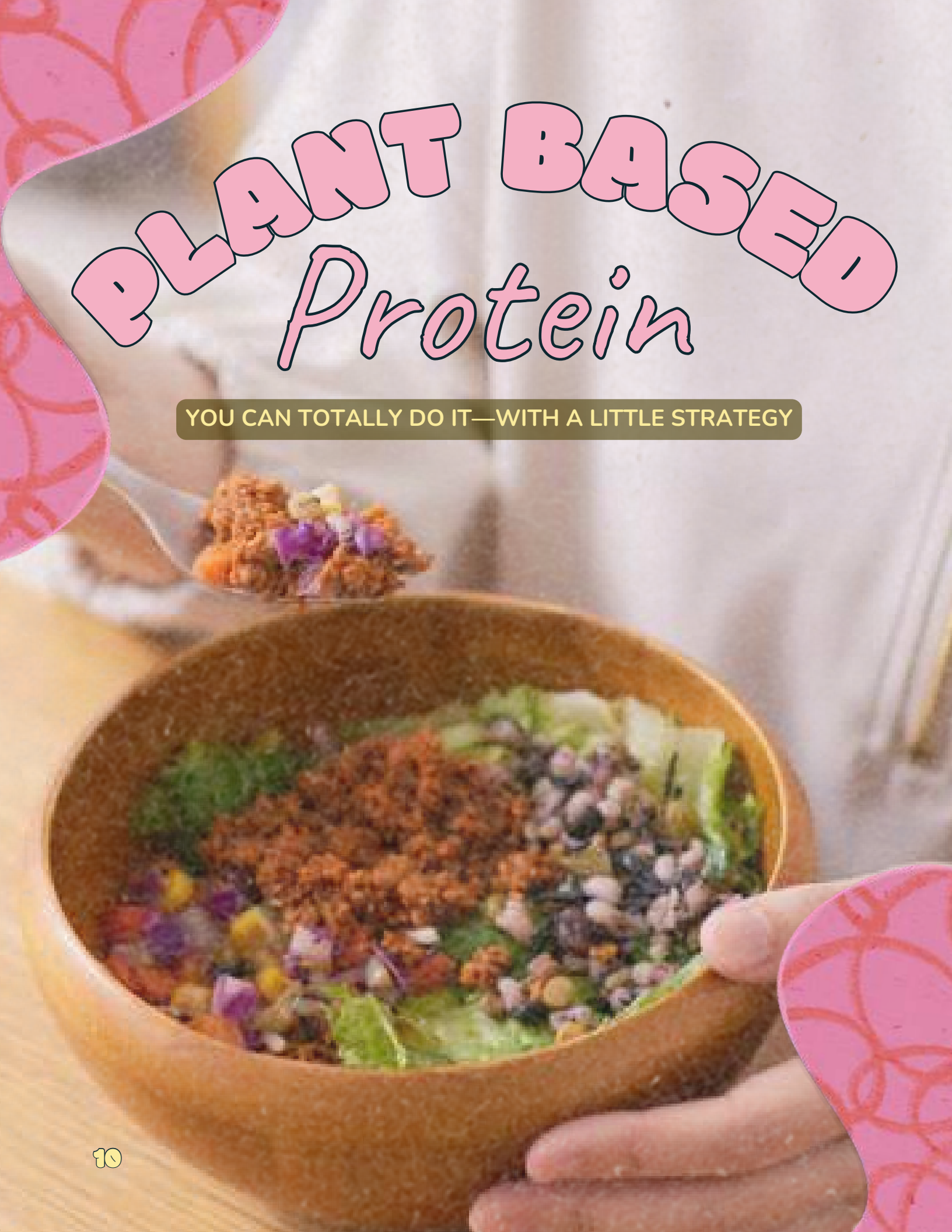
Not just a gym bro thing. Protein helps you build and repair muscle, keeps you full, supports hormone health (yes, queen), and is crucial during your follicular + ovulatory phases when energy is high and your body's ready to conquer the world. During the luteal phase, your metabolism slightly increases, and cravings might ramp up. Protein helps you stay full, stabilize blood sugar, and avoid the snack attacks.

Carbohydrates

Repeat after me: CARBS ARE NOT THE ENEMY. Especially during your luteal phase, when your body craves more fuel. Complex carbs (think sweet potatoes, quinoa, oats) keep your energy steady and your mood less chaotic. Simple carbs (like candy and white bread)? They're fine in moderation, but don't let them run the show.

Fats

The underrated queen. Healthy fats like avocado, olive oil, nuts, and seeds support hormone production and help absorb vitamins. They're especially important in your menstrual phase, when hormones drop and your body needs extra TLC.



PLANT BASED Protein

YOU CAN TOTALLY DO IT—WITH A LITTLE STRATEGY

Here's what no one tells you upfront: hitting your protein goals on a plant-based diet takes some planning.

Unlike animal protein, most plant sources don't contain all the essential amino acids (except soy). That doesn't mean they're bad, it just means you've gotta mix it up.

Power Moves for Plant-Based Protein:

- **Mix + Match**: Pair foods like rice + beans or hummus + whole grain pita to make complete proteins.
- **Lean on Legumes**: Chickpeas, lentils, black beans, and edamame are protein-packed AND fiber-rich.
- **Go Nuts (and Seeds)**: Almonds, chia, hemp, and flaxseeds are solid protein boosters with healthy fats on the side.
- **Tofu, Tempeh, Seitan** – The holy trinity of plant-based gains. Soy is a complete protein and one of my favorite plant-based go-tos.
- **Don't forget protein powders**: There are plenty of clean, plant-based options out there to make sure you're not falling short.

💡 **Cycle Syncing Tip:** Protein is your ride-or-die in every phase, but during your follicular and ovulatory phases, your body's primed for muscle building and higher energy output. In your luteal phase, that metabolism starts creeping up, protein helps you stay full, curb cravings, and keep blood sugar in check. Basically? Don't skip it, ever.

COMPLEX CARBS

Your body's not being dramatic, it actually needs more fuel during the luteal phase. Complex carbs like sweet potatoes, quinoa, and oats give you the slow, steady energy your body's begging for (and help keep mood swings from staging a coup). Simple carbs like candy or white bread? Totally okay in moderation, just don't let them take over your diet.

What Are Complex Carbs?

Think:

- Sweet potatoes
- Quinoa
- Brown rice
- Oats
- Beans & lentils
- Whole grain breads & pastas
- Veggies like broccoli, carrots, and squash

Unlike simple carbs (hi, donuts), complex carbs are packed with fiber, vitamins, and minerals that help regulate blood sugar, support digestion, and keep your energy stable throughout your cycle.

💡 Cycle Syncing Tip:

Your body needs more carbs during your luteal phase (that pre-period stretch where everything feels like a personal attack). This is when your metabolism naturally ramps up and your serotonin dips, complex carbs help balance mood, keep you full, and fight those premenstrual hanger pains.

FATS DESERVE A REBRAND

Healthy fats are essential, not optional. **They help your body actually make hormones,** absorb fat-soluble vitamins (like A, D, E, and K), support brain function, and keep you feeling satisfied, not ravenous an hour later.

During your menstrual and luteal phases, fats play a key role in calming inflammation, stabilizing mood swings, and supporting recovery. Basically, they're doing the work behind the scenes so you can keep being *that* girl.

Add these to your plate:

- Avocados (creamy AND functional? Iconic.)
- Olive oil + coconut oil (in moderation)
- Fatty fish (salmon, sardines, tuna)
- Nuts + seeds (flax, chia, walnuts...so many!)
- Nut butters (treat yourself to almond or cashew)
- Egg yolks (stop skipping them, they're gold)

Pro tip: It's all about quality. Think nourishing fats from whole foods, not deep-fried mystery meals. Remember, your hormones are watching.

Hormone-Happy Snack: The Mood-Stabilizer Toast

What you need:

- 1 slice of sprouted grain or sourdough bread (remember we're aiming for complex carbs)
- ½ avocado, mashed (rich in healthy fats + fiber)
- 1 boiled egg, sliced (protein + fat + vitamin D = chef's kiss)
- Sprinkle of hemp seeds (omega-3s + hormone support)
- Dash of sea salt + chili flakes (because you fancy)

Optional Add-On:
Drizzle with olive oil and add a side of dark chocolate square (magnesium-rich for mood + cravings = win-win)

WHAT'S SEED CYCLING, ANYWAY?

You may have heard this trend buzzing on your timeline recently. Seed cycling is a natural, food-based way to support your hormones through each phase of your cycle using specific seeds. Toss them in smoothies, sprinkle on oatmeal, or mix into energy balls. It's low effort, high reward.
Here's how it works:

Menstrual + Follicular (Days 1–14):

- Flaxseeds + Pumpkin Seeds
- These support estrogen production and metabolism. They're rich in omega-3s and lignans which help balance estrogen levels.

Ovulation + Luteal (Days 15–28):

- Sunflower + Sesame Seeds
- These help boost progesterone and reduce inflammation. They're loaded with zinc, selenium, and other hormone-friendly nutrients.

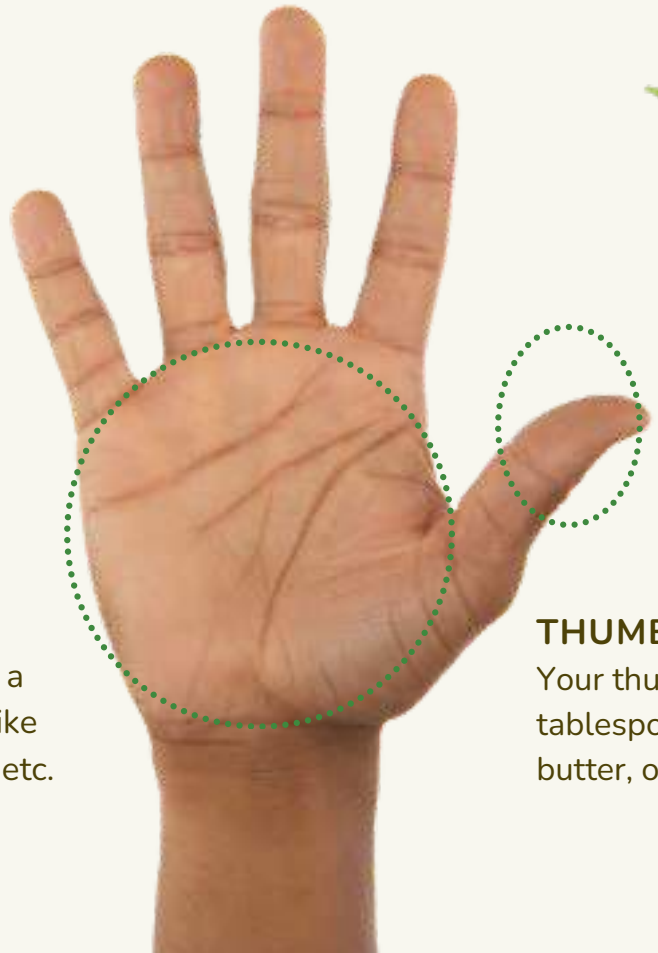
Visual Hand Guide To Portion Sizes

CUPPED HAND → CARBS

Your cupped hand is roughly ½ cup of carbohydrate-rich foods like rice, oats, pasta, beans, or potatoes.

FIST → VEGGIES

Your fist is roughly 1 cup of vegetables. Aim to fill up that fist!



PALM → PROTEIN

Your palm is roughly 3–4 oz, a standard serving of protein like chicken, fish, lean beef, tofu, etc.

THUMB → FATS

Your thumb is roughly 1 tablespoon of foods like nut butter, oils, or dressings.

FOOD LABELS 101

READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Nutrition labels can feel like decoding hieroglyphics. But once you know what to look for, you’ll be label-savvy in no time. Here’s what matters most (and what you can totally ignore)

What to Look For When Grocery Shopping

1 Serving Size Shenanigans

Always start here. That bag of chips might say 150 calories, but is that for the whole bag or just 6 sad chips? Companies love to play games, so check the serving size before you start munchin'.

2 The 5% / 20% Rule

This one's golden:

- 5% or less = low in that nutrient
- 20% or more = high in that nutrient

Use this to your advantage. Trying to cut back on sodium or added sugar? Look for 5% or less. Need more fiber or iron? Go for 20% or more. Boom.

3 Marketing Tricks

"Low-fat," "natural," "keto-friendly"? Yeah... cute, but meaningless without context. Always flip that box over and read the label instead of falling for the hype.

4 Ingredients List

Look for whole food ingredients. First few ingredients matter most as they make up the bulk of the product.

5

Sample Label for Macaroni and Cheese

Start Here

Limit these Nutrients

Get Enough of these Nutrients

Footnote

Quick Guide to % DV

5% or less is low

20% or more is high

Nutrition Facts

Serving Size 1 cup (228g)
Servings Per Container 2

Amount Per Serving

Calories 250	Calories from Fat 110
	% Daily Value*
Total Fat 12g	18%
Saturated Fat 3g	15%
Trans Fat 1.5g	
Cholesterol 30mg	10%
Sodium 470mg	20%
Total Carbohydrate 31g	10%
Dietary Fiber 0g	0%
Sugars 5g	
Protein 5g	
Vitamin A	4%
Vitamin C	2%
Calcium	20%
Iron	4%

* Percent Daily Values are based on a 2,000 calorie diet. Your Daily Values may be higher or lower depending on your calorie needs:

	Calories:	2,000	2,500
Total Fat	Less than	65g	80g
Sat Fat	Less than	20g	25g
Cholesterol	Less than	300mg	300mg
Sodium	Less than	2,400mg	2,400mg
Total Carbohydrate		300g	375g
Dietary Fiber		25g	30g

💡 **Quick Tip:** The fewer the ingredients, the better (most of the time). Keep it simple, sis.

COMMON NUTRITION MYTHS (THAT NEED TO RETIRE)

BETWEEN TIKTOK TRENDS, “WHAT I EAT IN A DAY” VIDEOS, AND EVERYONE SUDDENLY BECOMING AN EXPERT, IT’S HARD TO KNOW WHAT’S REAL AND WHAT’S JUST RECYCLED BS.

So let’s break down a few of the biggest myths that keep getting passed around like bad hand-me-downs....

❌ Fasting Is the Secret to Fat Loss

Not necessarily. Fasting can work for some people, but it isn't a requirement for fat loss or better health. Your body still needs enough energy and nutrients to support your hormones, muscles, mood, and daily life. If fasting leaves you constantly hungry, low-energy, or thinking about food all day, it may not be the right approach for you. You don't have to skip meals (especially breakfast) to see results.

❌ You Can't Have Dessert While Cycle Syncing

Nope! Food is not a reward or punishment. You can enjoy dessert, and you should, just make sure it's in line with your body's needs. A little dark chocolate, some fruit, or a homemade treat that fits into your phase won't derail your progress. Remember, it's all about moderation and making it work for your body.

❌ You Can Just Burn It Off with Cardio

Newsflash: you can't out-exercise a consistently unbalanced diet. **Your body doesn't work like a debit card** where you swipe a treat and "pay it off" on the treadmill. Nourish yourself and move because it feels good, not as punishment.

❌ You Need a Meal Plan to Be Successful

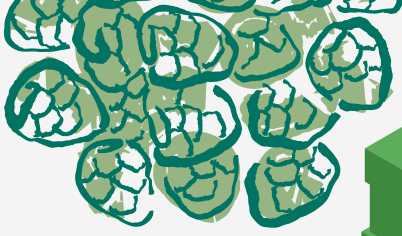
Meal plans are cute... until life happens. What you really need is food freedom, not another rulebook. Because when you learn why you're eating something, **you'll make empowered choices,** whether you're at home or ordering appetizers on date night.

PILL$, POWDER$ & PROMI$ES

WHAT'S ACTUALLY WORTH TAKING

I'M JUST SAYING...MOST OF THE SUPPLEMENTS OUT THERE ARE DOING MORE FOR YOUR PEE THAN YOUR BODY.

"If you're eating a mostly whole foods diet and not dealing with a diagnosed deficiency, you probably don't need most of what's on the shelf"



The Supplement Trap (And What You Actually Need)

We're living in a time where wellness influencers are out here peddling mystery powders and $60 hormonal blends like they're selling secrets of the universe. And listen, I get it. We want to feel better, have more energy, balance our hormones, and reclaim our health. But here's the kicker...

If you're eating a mostly whole foods diet and not dealing with a diagnosed deficiency, you probably don't need most of what's on the shelf. A lot of us are self-diagnosing, adding handfuls of gummies to our morning routine, hoping for a miracle. But here's the real tea (pun intended):

You can't out-supplement a lack of sleep, a trash diet, or chronic stress. And yes, there's valid mistrust in the medical system—especially for Black and brown women. But before you pop your multivitamin in protest of Big Pharma, remember: Some of these wellness brands are serving the same "trust us, we know best" energy just with prettier fonts and no receipts.

The same supplement companies that tell you not to trust "Big Pharma" are... kinda starting to look like Big Pharma. Same manipulation, different packaging. So what's actually worth your money? Here are a few I recommend to all my clients :

Creatine

The gym bro supplement that loves your hormones too.

Benefits:

- Boosts strength, endurance, and muscle recovery
- Supports cognitive function and mental clarity
- Helps reduce brain fog + fatigue (especially helpful in luteal phase!)
- Supports hormonal health by preserving lean muscle mass and boosting energy during high-hormone phases

How to use:
3–5g daily, mixed in water or a smoothie. No need to cycle or "load."

Magnesium

The calm, cool, collected queen of your supplement shelf.

Benefits:

- Promotes deep sleep + muscle recovery
- Helps regulate stress hormones like cortisol
- Supports estrogen detox and eases PMS symptoms (bloating, cramps, mood swings)
- Helps reduce anxiety and stabilize mood (especially pre-period)

Best forms:

- Glycinate (for calm + sleep)
- Malate (for energy + muscle support)
- Citrate (for digestion, but can be too intense for some)

Protein

Because sometimes life gets busy, but your protein goals still matter.

Why they're helpful:

- A convenient way to increase your protein intake when you're short on time
- Can help you reach your daily protein goal without adding a large amount of calories
- Especially useful when you're in a calorie deficit and want to prioritize protein while managing your overall calorie intake
- Great for busy mornings, post-workout, or as a quick snack when a full meal isn't practical

Pro tip: Use protein shakes, powders, or other protein supplements to supplement your nutrition, not replace it. Your meals should still provide a variety of whole foods, fiber, healthy fats, carbohydrates, and micronutrients. Think of a protein supplement as a convenient tool to help you fill the gaps when you need it.

Bonus: You can get magnesium from food too! Think leafy greens (like spinach), pumpkin seeds, almonds, black beans, dark chocolate (yes, please), and even avocado.

Still, most of us don't get enough from food alone—especially when stress depletes our stores—so supplementing can help fill the gap.

Optional perk:

If you're looking for useful supplements, my code THEROSETTATONE can get you 30% off at Gainful.com Totally optional, of course!

Eating Out & Traveling

WITHOUT THE GUILT

Plot twist: You can hit your goals without skipping date night or packing a suitcase full of protein bars. The key? Strategy over stress.

Dining Out Like a Nutritional Baddie:

- **Peep the menu ahead of time.** Having a game plan means less pressure at the table.
- **Look for lean proteins & veggies** Grilled > fried. Roasted > drowned in sauce.
- **Ask for sauces/dressings on the side** You're the boss, not the bottle. (Corny, I know)
- **Balance your plate** – Think: protein + fiber + healthy fat. Refer to the Macros, Macros, Macros, (pg. 10) Easy formula, any cuisine.

Travel Without Throwing Your Nutrition Out the Window:

- **Pack smart snacks** – Protein bars (check the labels though), nuts, jerky, fruit. TSA-approved and drama-free.
- **Hydrate** – Especially on flights. Water is still queen.
- **Don't skip meals** – Skipping just leads to ravenous decisions (hello, airport pretzel stand).
- **Prioritize protein** – Airport food can be hit or miss, so when you're grabbing a meal, look for a solid protein source first. Think eggs, Greek yogurt, chicken, turkey, or a protein-packed bowl.

💡 **Cycle Syncing Tip:** If you're in your luteal phase, cravings and hunger might spike. Be gentle with yourself. Plan ahead, bring snacks, and don't panic if your appetite is a little louder than usual. You're not "failing," you're cycling.

Before You Raise A Glass

Bottomless mimosas have gotten the best of us. Between brunch, happy hour and dinners, alcohol is part of many social events, which makes it tough to completely eliminate but it can also impact your health and fitness goals. The key is knowing how it fits into your overall nutrition.

Remember, you don't have to cut out alcohol completely, just be mindful of how it fits into your overall lifestyle and goals.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW:

- Alcohol has 7 calories per gram, making it almost as calorie-dense as fat. These are "empty" calories, meaning **they provide no nutritional value**.
- **It can slow down fat burning** because your body prioritizes breaking down alcohol over other macros.
- It may also increase cravings and lower inhibitions, making it **easier to overeat.**

SMART STRATEGIES FOR DRINKING:

- Moderation is key: Try to stick to 1 drink per day as recommended for women.
- Choose wisely: **Opt for lower-calorie options** like spirits with soda water, light beer, or dry wines. I personally love White Claws.
- Plan ahead: If you know you're going out, **balance your day with lean protein and veggies** to leave room for the drinks.

Hydrate: Drink water between alcoholic beverages to stay hydrated and reduce hangover effects.

HOT GIRL MEAL PREP

Between work, workouts, and keeping your life together, the last thing you need is to be staring into the fridge at 7 p.m. wondering what to eat.

No, we're not talking about perfectly portioned, color-coordinated meals stacked in glass containers (unless that's your thing).

Batch Cook the Basics: Grill a bunch of protein (chicken, tofu, shrimp, whatever you vibe with), roast a few trays of veggies, and cook up a carb source like rice or sweet potatoes. Mix and match all week.

Snack Smart: Stock up on grab-and-go options like hard-boiled eggs, Greek yogurt, protein bars, or hummus with veggies.

Plan to Wing It: Got a busy week? Even prepping just two meals ahead gives future-you a huge win.

One-Pan = No Drama: Sheet pan meals and one-pot dishes are the ish for of low-effort cooking.

Flavor is Your Friend: Keep sauces, dips, and seasonings on deck. Boring food = a fast track to Uber Eats.

That's a Wrap, Babe

YOU MADE IT THROUGH AND HOPEFULLY YOU'RE FEELING A LITTLE MORE INFORMED, A LITTLE MORE EMPOWERED, AND A WHOLE LOT MORE IN TUNE WITH THE MAGIC OF YOUR BODY.

Ready for more? Want personalized help syncing your fitness and nutrition with your cycle? I'm here to help! As a NASM Certified Personal Trainer and Nutrition Coach, I can provide coaching and support to help you build sustainable habits.

How I Can Help You:

- **Keep you accountable so you stay on track and see real progress.** Because if you could do it on your own, you would have already. But I got you, sis.
- **Calculate your calorie intake** to align with your specific health goals.
- **Break down the fundamentals of nutrition** in a simple, no-BS way.
- **Guide you in creating balanced meals** using foods you actually enjoy.
- **Tailor your workouts** to each phase of your cycle to align with your fitness goals, if cycle syncing aligns with your goals.
- **Help you sync your nutrition with your cycle** so you can fuel your body based on your hormones, because what your body needs in the follicular phase isn't the same as in the luteal phase!

train with your hormones not against them

Scan to Apply